

inch display that offers pretty decent video playback. How long would it take a person, the kind who would splurge on this phone, to cram every last nook and cranny in that Flash drive with data? And then they'll want more and they won't be able to have it—and this would certainly not make them happy. There is no such thing as enough storage. Apple should ideally have provided a much higher capacity drive on this thing or at least should have provided a way to expand the memory with memory cards.

The battery

If you have seen an iPod, you know that its battery is fixed in place and is not replaceable by the user. The day your battery snuffs it, you'll have to send the unit to Apple and they'll replace it for you. Well, if the iPhone uses the iPod's dock, is compatible with its accessories, uses the same software to connect to a computer, and is made by the same company—how can it not inherit its predecessor's nagging traits? One might argue that since this battery problem did not affect sales of the iPod, it isn't very likely to affect the iPhone either. However, it is one thing to live without one's music for a few days, but a completely different thing altogether to part with your phone for even a single day. Whether it will affect the iPhone's overall sales will be decided when the phone actually hits the market, but this was a drawback with the iPod and is an even more significant one with the iPhone.

Price

All those entire new and innovative features in a pint sized device. Seems quite a feat, but that feat costs quite a lot of money to achieve, and who better to bear the brunt of all those expenses than the customer? The iPhone costs \$499 for the 4 GB version and \$599 for the 8 GB version in the USA. In terms of direct conversion, that amounts to about Rs 22,000 and Rs 26,300 respectively. That seems quite reasonable for the number of features it offers. But direct conversion is not the way to go. For one thing, the iPhone comes with a two year contract of using the phone with a Cingular connection which considerably reduces the price of the phone. But such a system is not prevalent in India on the GSM network.